📜 Indian History — Flowchart Memory Map

Ancient · Medieval · Modern — dynasties, movements & the freedom struggle drawn as trees, timelines & mnemonics so the sequence sticks in one glance.

Target post: ASO · Tier-I General Awareness · NCERT-level scope. Every block tagged by priority.

P1 High-yield — do first P2 Medium P3 Low / rare 🧠 = mnemonic

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🗓️ **2026-07-04** · **Topic of the day:** Bhakti & Sufi saints — Nirguna vs Saguna rotates daily

🕰️ The Whole Syllabus as a Timeline P1

Start here. Every dynasty below hangs off one of three eras. Picture the arrow of time: **Ancient** → **Medieval** → **Modern**.

INDIAN HISTORY — the Time Arrow

ANCIENT
- Indus Valley (c.2500 BC)
- Vedic Age (1500–600 BC)
- Buddhism & Jainism (6th c. BC)
- Mahajanapadas & Magadha
- Mauryas (322–185 BC)
- Guptas (c.319–550 AD) — Golden Age

MEDIEVAL
- Harsha & Rajputs
- Delhi Sultanate (1206–1526)
- Bhakti & Sufi movements
- Vijayanagara & Bahmani
- Mughals (1526–1857)

MODERN
- European trading companies
- Plassey 1757 · Buxar 1764
- British Raj & Acts
- Revolt of 1857
- Freedom Movement (1885–1947)

🧠 **"Vedic Buddha ne Maurya-Gupta banaya, phir Sultanate-Mughal aaye, aakhir mein Angrez."** — that one line is the spine of the whole subject.

☸️ Buddhism & Jainism — the 6th-century Twins P1

Both born in 6th c. BC as a revolt against Vedic ritual/caste. SSC asks founder, place, terms & councils. Learn them side by side.

POINT	BUDDHISM	JAINISM	TAG
Founder	Gautama Buddha (Siddhartha) — 563–483 BC	Mahavira (Vardhamana) — 24th & last Tirthankara; 1st = Rishabhadeva	P1
Core aim	End suffering → attain **Nirvana**	Liberate soul → attain **Kaivalya (Moksha)**	P2
Key doctrine	Four Noble Truths + Eightfold Path (Middle Path)	Triratna + Five Vows + **Syadvada** (theory of "maybe")	P1
Sacred texts	**Tripitaka** (Vinaya, Sutta, Abhidhamma) — in Pali	Angas / Agamas — in Prakrit	P2
Sects	Hinayana & Mahayana	Digambara (sky-clad) & Svetambara (white-clad)	P2
Symbol	Wheel (Dharmachakra), Bodhi tree, lotus	Each Tirthankara has an emblem (Mahavira = lion)	P3

BUDDHA — 4 life events, 4 places

Born	**Lumbini** (Nepal)
Enlightenment	**Bodh Gaya** (under Bodhi tree)
First Sermon	**Sarnath** (Dharmachakra Pravartana)
Death (Mahaparinirvana)	**Kushinagar**

🧠 **"Lumbini Bodh Sarnath Kushi"** = Born → Enlightened → First Sermon → Died. Order = alphabet of his life.

Jain Triratna & 5 Vows

Triratna

- Right Faith
- Right Knowledge
- Right Conduct

5 Vows

- Ahimsa
- Satya
- Asteya (no stealing)
- Aparigraha (non-possession)
- Brahmacharya*

🧠 ***5th vow (celibacy) was ADDED by Mahavira** — first 23 Tirthankaras taught only 4. Triratna = **"Faith · Knowledge · Conduct"**.

Four Noble Truths: (1) There is suffering, (2) suffering has a cause (desire), (3) suffering can end, (4) the way to end it = **Eightfold Path** (right view, intention, speech, action, livelihood, effort, mindfulness, concentration).

Buddhist Councils — who, where, when

COUNCIL	PLACE	PATRON KING	HIGHLIGHT	TAG
1st	Rajgir (Rajagriha)	Ajatashatru	Compiled Buddha's teachings (Vinaya & Sutta)	P1
2nd	Vaishali	Kalashoka	Split into Sthaviravadins & Mahasanghikas	P2
3rd	Pataliputra	**Ashoka**	Compiled Abhidhamma; missionaries sent abroad	P1
4th	Kashmir (Kundalavana)	**Kanishka**	Split into Hinayana & Mahayana	P1

🧠 Councils = **"Raja Vaishali Patal Kashmir"** → Rajgir · Vaishali · Pataliputra · Kashmir. Kings = **Ajatashatru** → **Kalashoka** → **Ashoka** → **Kanishka** ("A-K-A-K").

🦁 Mauryan Empire (322–185 BC) P1

India's first great empire. Founded by Chandragupta with Chanakya's help; peaked under Ashoka. Capital = Pataliputra.

MAURYA — line of succession

Chandragupta → Founder; guided by **Chanakya (Kautilya)**, author of **Arthashastra**; defeated Seleucus; turned Jain in old age (died at Shravanabelagola)

Bindusara → "Amitraghata" (slayer of foes); extended empire to Deccan

Ashoka → Greatest Maurya; **Kalinga War 261 BC** → embraced Buddhism & **Dhamma**

🧠 Succession = **"Chai Bina Ashant"** → **Ch**andragupta → **Bin**dusara → **Ash**oka.

Kalinga War (261 BC): The bloodshed changed Ashoka — he gave up conquest (Digvijaya) for "conquest by Dhamma" (Dhammavijaya), spread Buddhism, and inscribed **Rock & Pillar Edicts** in Prakrit/Brahmi script across the empire.

Megasthenes was the Greek ambassador of Seleucus at Chandragupta's court; he wrote **"Indica"** describing Mauryan society & Pataliputra. Ashoka's edicts were deciphered by **James Prinsep**.

🧠 The **Lion Capital of Sarnath** (Ashoka) = India's National Emblem; "Satyameva Jayate" is from the Mundaka Upanishad.

✨ Gupta Empire — the "Golden Age" (c.319–550 AD) P1

Peace + prosperity + a burst of science, art & literature. Learn the 3 great Guptas as a chain.

GUPTA — the golden chain

Chandragupta I → Real founder of the empire; started the **Gupta Era (319–20 AD)**; married Licchavi princess

Samudragupta → **"Napoleon of India"** (V.A. Smith); conquests recorded in the **Allahabad/Prayag Prashasti** by Harisena

Chandragupta II → **"Vikramaditya"**; defeated the Shakas; Chinese pilgrim **Fa-Hien** visited; court had the **Navaratnas**

🧠 Golden chain = **"Chandra → Samudra → Chandra (Vikram)"**. Samudragupta = **Samudra** ("ocean") of conquests = Napoleon.

🔢 Aryabhata

Astronomer-mathematician; concept of **zero & decimal** system; "Aryabhatiya" P1

🏛️ Nalanda

Great Buddhist university flourished in this era P2

📖 Kalidasa

Greatest Sanskrit poet — "Abhijnanashakuntalam", "Meghaduta" P2

Why "Golden Age": decimal system & zero, Aryabhata & Varahamihira (science), Kalidasa (literature), fine gold coins, Ajanta paintings, Nalanda. Empire ended with **Huna** invasions.

🙏 Bhakti & Sufi Movement P2

Medieval devotional movements stressing love of God over ritual. Bhakti = Hindu saints; Sufi = Islamic mystics. SSC asks "saint → region → idea".

BHAKTI — the two schools

NIRGUNA — formless God

Idea God has no form; reject idols & caste

Saints Kabir · Guru Nanak

SAGUNA — God with form

Idea Devotion to a personal God (Rama/Krishna)

Saints Tulsidas · Mirabai · Surdas · Chaitanya

Bhakti saints — region & idea

SAINT	REGION	IDEA / NOTE	TAG
Shankaracharya	Kerala	Advaita (non-dualism) philosophy; established 4 mathas	P2
Ramananda	North India	Brought Bhakti to the north; teacher of Kabir	P2
Kabir	North (Banaras)	Nirguna; unity of Hindu-Muslim; "Dohas" (Bijak)	P1
Guru Nanak	Punjab	Founder of **Sikhism**; one God, equality	P1
Chaitanya	Bengal	Krishna Bhakti; Kirtan & Sankirtan	P2
Mirabai	Rajasthan	Devotee of Krishna; famous bhajans	P2
Tulsidas	North (Awadhi)	Wrote **Ramcharitmanas**; Rama devotee	P2

Sufi (Islamic mysticism): Moinuddin Chishti (founded Chishti order in India; dargah at Ajmer) · **Nizamuddin Auliya** (Delhi; "Mahbub-e-Ilahi") · concept of **Khanqah** (hospice) & **Silsila** (order). Both movements promoted communal harmony.

🧠 **Kabir & Nanak = Nirguna**; Tulsi/Mira/Surdas/Chaitanya = Saguna. Sufi biggies = **"Moinuddin in Ajmer, Nizamuddin in Delhi."**

🕌 Mughal Empire & Administration (1526–1857) P2

Founded by Babur after the **First Battle of Panipat (1526)**. Learn the 6 great rulers in order, then Akbar's admin machinery.

THE SIX GREAT MUGHALS

Babur → Founder; won Panipat 1526 vs Ibrahim Lodi; wrote "Baburnama"

Humayun → Lost to Sher Shah Suri; regained throne 1555; died falling from library stairs

Akbar → Greatest; won 2nd Panipat 1556; Din-i-Ilahi, Mansabdari, Navaratnas

Jahangir → Married Nur Jahan; peak of Mughal painting

Shah Jahan → "Golden Age" of architecture — **Taj Mahal**, Red Fort, Jama Masjid

Aurangzeb → Last powerful Mughal; re-imposed Jizya; empire's greatest extent then decline

🧠 **"Baby Humne Akbar Jaha Shah Aur"** = **Ba**bur · **Hu**mayun · **Akbar** · **Jaha**ngir · **Shah** Jahan · **Au**rangzeb (a.k.a. "BHAJSA").

Akbar's administration

SYSTEM	WHAT IT DID	TAG
Mansabdari	Ranking system of nobles/officers; rank = "Zat" (status) & "Sawar" (cavalry) — ran the army & bureaucracy	P1
Land revenue (Zabti / Dahsala)	Devised by **Raja Todar Mal**; land measured & revenue fixed in cash on averages	P1
Din-i-Ilahi (1582)	Akbar's syncretic faith blending all religions; few followers	P2
Navaratnas	9 gems of the court — Birbal, Todar Mal, Tansen, Abul Fazl, Raja Man Singh, etc.	P2

🧠 **Revenue = Todar Mal** (Zabti/Dahsala). **Din-i-Ilahi** = Akbar's "one religion for all". Abul Fazl wrote **Ain-i-Akbari** & Akbarnama.

⚔️ Major Wars & Battles — Year · Place · Cause → Effect P1

SSC's favourite one-liners live here. Each card = **Year · matchup (winner in green) · why it happened → what it caused**. Learn the card shape, not a list.

1st Panipat P1 — 1526 · Panipat

Babur ⚔️ Ibrahim Lodi

⚡ **CAUSE**
Babur invited to overthrow the Lodi sultan

💥 **EFFECT**
Founded the **Mughal Empire**; 1st field artillery in India

Khanwa P3 — 1527

Babur ⚔️ Rana Sanga

⚡ **CAUSE**
Rajput confederacy resisted Mughal rule

💥 **EFFECT**
Cemented Mughal power in North India

2nd Panipat P2 — 1556 · Panipat

Akbar (Bairam Khan) ⚔️ Hemu

CAUSE	EFFECT
Hemu seized Delhi after Humayun's death	Re-established Mughal rule; began Akbar's reign

Haldighati P2

1576

Akbar (Man Singh) ⚔ Maharana Pratap

CAUSE	EFFECT
Mewar refused Mughal submission	Indecisive; Pratap kept up guerrilla resistance

3rd Panipat P1

1761 · Panipat

Ahmad Shah Abdali ⚔ Marathas

CAUSE	EFFECT
Maratha expansion clashed with the Afghan invader	Broke Maratha power → cleared the way for the **British**

Plassey P1

1757 · Bengal

British (Clive) ⚔ Siraj-ud-Daulah

CAUSE	EFFECT
Trade dispute & "Black Hole"; Mir Jafar's betrayal	British foothold in **Bengal** — Company rule begins

Buxar P1

1764 · Buxar

British ⚔ Mir Qasim + Shuja + Shah Alam II

CAUSE	EFFECT
Nawabs tried to throw off British control	British win **Diwani** of Bengal-Bihar-Odisha (1765) = real power

🧠 **Three Panipats = 1526 · 1556 · 1761** ("Babur, Akbar, Abdali"). **Plassey (1757) → Buxar (1764)**: 7 years apart; Plassey = foothold, Buxar = legal power (Diwani).

Anglo-regional wars (effect = British paramountcy): Anglo-Mysore (Tipu Sultan, d.1799 at Srirangapatnam) · Anglo-Maratha (ended Maratha power, 1818) · Anglo-Sikh (annexed Punjab, 1849). Each war ended with the British absorbing another region.

IN Modern History & Freedom Movement P1

Don't read it — **ride it**. Each stop on this line is one milestone on the journey to 1947. Picture the icon + year; the detail is just the caption.

🏁 **START · British power grows**



Plassey P1

Clive beats Siraj-ud-Daulah (Mir Jafar betrays) → British **foothold in Bengal**



Buxar P1

British win → **Diwani** of Bengal (1765) = real revenue power



The Great Revolt P1

Spark = greased cartridges; **Mangal Pandey** fires first; Lakshmibai · Tantia Tope · Nana Sahib. **Failed** → Crown takes over



INC founded P1

Congress born — **A.O. Hume**; 1st president W.C. Bonnerjee



Partition of Bengal P1

Curzon splits Bengal → ignites the **Swadeshi Movement**



Jallianwala Bagh P1

Rowlatt Act → Gen. Dyer fires at Amritsar → nationwide outrage



Non-Cooperation P1

Gandhi's first mass movement · called off after **Chauri Chaura (1922)**



Dandi Salt March P1

Civil Disobedience — Gandhi breaks the salt law



Quit India P1

"**Do or Die**" — demand for immediate British exit



FREEDOM! · 15 Aug P1

Independence + partition into India & Pakistan (Mountbatten Plan)

🏁 **DESTINATION · 1947**

🧠 Ride the icons: ⚔️💰 (British rise) → 🔥 1857 → 🏛️🛠️🩸 (Congress · Partition · Jallianwala) → 🚫🧂✊ (Gandhi's 3 movements: NCM→CDM→Quit India) → IN. Gandhi's three are ~a decade apart: 1920 · 1930 · 1942.

Why 1857 failed: limited to north/central India, no common ideal, poor organisation, better British arms & resources, some rulers stayed loyal. Result: **GoI Act 1858** ended Company rule; Queen Victoria's Proclamation.

🧶 Freedom Movement — Cause → Event → Effect Chains P1

The timeline tells you *when*; this shows *why it started → what it caused*. Each block is a diagram: read ⚡ **Cause** → **EVENT** → 💥 **Effect**.

THE CHAIN OF ANGER — each step triggers the next

1905 Partition of Bengal (Curzon) → sparks Swadeshi

↓

1919 Rowlatt Act → Jallianwala Bagh massacre

↓

1920 Non-Cooperation Movement launched

↓

1922 Chauri Chaura violence → NCM **called off**

↓

1930 Civil Disobedience — Dandi Salt March

↓

1942 Quit India — "Do or Die"

↓

1947 Independence IN

Each movement's *repression or failure* becomes the *cause* of the next — that's the whole logic of the struggle.

Each flashpoint as a Cause → Event → Effect diagram

Revolt of 1857

1857 · Meerut → Delhi / Jhansi / Kanpur / Lucknow **P1**

⚡ **CAUSE**

Greased cartridges (cow & pig fat), Doctrine of Lapse, ecc ic exploitation, anger in the Bengal Army

↓

💥 **EFFECT**

Company rule ended → **GoI Act 1858** (power to the Crov Mughal Empire abolished (Bahadur Shah II exiled)

Partition of Bengal

1905 · Bengal (Curzon) **P1**

⚡ **CAUSE**

British "divide & rule" — split Bengal on religious lines to ken nationalism

↓

💥 **EFFECT**

Triggered the **Swadeshi & Boycott Movement**; boosted n industry; annulled in 1911

Jallianwala Bagh

13 Apr 1919 · Amritsar **P1**

⚡ **CAUSE**

Rowlatt Act (arrest without trial) → mass protest; Gen. **D** red on a peaceful crowd

↓

💥 **EFFECT**

National outrage; Tagore returned his knighthood; fuelled **Non-Cooperation Movement**

Non-Cooperation Movement

1920–22 · nationwide **P1**

⚡ **CAUSE**

Jallianwala Bagh + Rowlatt + Khilafat issue; Gandhi's call t ycott British goods/titles/schools

↓

💥 **EFFECT**

First mass movement; **called off after Chauri Chaura (19** when a mob turned violent

Civil Disobedience / Dandi

1930 · Dandi (Gujarat) P1

⚡ CAUSE

Demand for **Purna Swaraj** (Lahore 1929) + the hated **Sal** (British salt monopoly)

↓

💥 EFFECT

Gandhi broke the salt law → mass law-breaking; led to th **und Table Conferences** & Gandhi-Irwin Pact

Quit India Movement

1942 · Bombay (Aug Kranti) P1

⚡ CAUSE

Failure of the **Cripps Mission**; WWII hardship; demand fo nediate British exit

↓

💥 EFFECT

"**Do or Die**"; leaders jailed; the last great mass movement ore freedom

Independence

15 Aug 1947 P1

⚡ CAUSE

Mountbatten Plan + Indian Independence Act 1947; cor nal tension made partition unavoidable

↓

💥 EFFECT

Two dominions — **India & Pakistan**; Radcliffe Line drawn ss migration

Why movements were called off / failed (common exam point): NCM → violence at **Chauri Chaura (1922)**; 1857 → no unity/leadership/modern arms. Success came only when mass pressure + WWII-weakened Britain met in 1945–47.

📜 Important Acts of British India P2

SSC loves "Which Act introduced ___?" Learn each act by its one big innovation.

ACT	YEAR	WHAT IT DID (ONE LINE)	TAG
Regulating Act	1773	First step to control the Company; Warren Hastings = 1st Governor-General of Bengal	P1
Pitt's India Act	1784	Dual control — a Board of Control over the Company (govt + Company together)	P2
Charter Act	1833	Governor-General of **India** (1st = William Bentinck); ended Company's trade monopoly	P2
Government of India Act	1858	Ended Company rule → power to the **British Crown**; office of Secretary of State	P1
Morley-Minto (IC Act)	1909	Introduced **separate electorates** for Muslims (communal representation)	P1
Montagu-Chelmsford (GoI Act)	1919	**Dyarchy** in provinces (subjects split into reserved & transferred)	P1
Government of India Act	1935	Provincial autonomy; federal scheme — the "blueprint" of our Constitution	P1

🧠 **1909 = separate electorates · 1919 = Dyarchy · 1935 = Provincial autonomy**. Company died in **1858**; GG of India began **1833**.

⚡ 60-Second Rapid Revision P1

PROMPT	ANSWER
Buddha born / enlightened at	Lumbini / Bodh Gaya
Buddha's first sermon / death at	Sarnath / Kushinagar
Buddhist sacred text	Tripitaka (in Pali)
24th & 1st Tirthankara	Mahavira / Rishabhadeva
Jain "theory of maybe"	Syadvada
3rd Buddhist Council — where / king	Pataliputra / Ashoka

PROMPT	ANSWER
4th Buddhist Council — where / king	Kashmir / Kanishka
Founder of Mauryan Empire	Chandragupta Maurya
Author of Arthashastra	Chanakya (Kautilya)
Kalinga War year	261 BC
Greek ambassador who wrote "Indica"	Megasthenes
Founder of Gupta era	Chandragupta I (319–20 AD)
"Napoleon of India"	Samudragupta
Chandragupta II's title / pilgrim visitor	Vikramaditya / Fa-Hien
Mathematician who gave zero	Aryabhata
Founder of Sikhism	Guru Nanak
Kabir & Nanak belonged to	Nirguna Bhakti
Chishti Sufi saint at Ajmer	Moinuddin Chishti
Founder of Mughal Empire	Babur (Panipat 1526)
Akbar's revenue minister / system	Todar Mal / Zabti (Dahsala)
Akbar's religion	Din-i-Ilahi (1582)
Taj Mahal built by	Shah Jahan
Battle of Plassey / Buxar	1757 / 1764
Three Battles of Panipat	1526 · 1556 · 1761
3rd Panipat — between / effect	Abdali vs Marathas / broke Maratha power
Effect of Battle of Buxar	British got Diwani of Bengal (1765)
Who fired first shot in 1857	Mangal Pandey
1857 revolt — main spark / effect	Greased cartridges / Crown rule (Act 1858)
Cause of Swadeshi Movement	Partition of Bengal (1905, Curzon)
Rowlatt Act led to	Jallianwala Bagh massacre (1919)

PROMPT	ANSWER
NCM called off after	Chauri Chaura incident (1922)
Cause of Quit India (1942)	Failure of the Cripps Mission
INC founded / by whom	1885 / A.O. Hume
Jallianwala Bagh massacre	1919, Amritsar (Gen. Dyer)
Salt March / Dandi	1930 (Civil Disobedience)
"Do or Die" slogan	Quit India Movement, 1942
Act that ended Company rule	Government of India Act 1858
Separate electorates introduced by	Morley-Minto Act 1909
Dyarchy in provinces introduced by	Montagu-Chelmsford Act 1919
India's Independence date	15 August 1947

PYQ pattern: "Where did Buddha attain enlightenment?" → Bodh Gaya. · "Who was the Napoleon of India?" → Samudragupta. · "Separate electorates were introduced by which Act?" → Morley-Minto 1909.
